

Skype for Android vulnerable

Profile data and instant messages stored in Skype on Android devices could be stolen by malicious third party code

Google concerned privacy

Google to implement mobile user privacy through double anonymisation, easy opt-out's and in-app notices

Industry Connect

audio signal and improve the listening experience. Some of them are listed below.

Basic processing algorithm

such as equalization (EQ)

Bass Boost algorithm improve bass response of small speakers

Virtualization algorithms increase the size of the audio field and are able to effectively create virtual surround sound even from smaller portable devices.

What are the factors one needs to consider before buying an audio system?

Consumers in India look for audio quality, formats the system can play, support for decoding, cost, ease of installation.

Are the high prices for supposedly audio-ophile-grade audio equipment justified?

High-end audio equipments have the highest standards such as SNR, THD and sampling rates that ensure a rich user experience. These features require complex digital signal processing, state of art data converters and amplifiers.

How has semiconductors changed this field?

Consumers demand the best performance in their audio products. They want crystal-clear sound wherever they are - in whatever format they want to use. We provide technology that enhances the listener's audio experience, offering high performance, unparalleled integration and design flexibility. Our program-mable components help you build audio systems with true, life-like sound and broad functionality at a competitive cost.

High-quality digital audio formats such as lossless HD found on Blu-ray discs present AV receiver system designers with many engineering challenges. Digital connectivity, content protection, compatibility with new decoding standards and the need for fast data rates with superior analog performance throughout the entire audio signal chain require careful attention to semiconductor device selection, power supply design and PCB layout. This is where we play an important role.

Shouldn't price be reducing with semiconductors?

Cost is driven by performance

IMAGINE IMATION

Imation plans a serious India foray. Here's the info on some of their short and long term initiatives.

It's been a while since we've heard about Imation. What has it been up to?

Imation has transformed in to a global technology company. We are currently the global leaders in branded optical media category (CDs and DVDs). We also ventured in to Blu-ray discs. Imation has also extended its reach in IT and computer accessories such as keyboards, mice, web cams and speakers. Apart from its legacy in backup storage tapes, we also have hard disk-based backup storage such as RDX.

Can you shed some light on the dynamics of the optical storage media industry?

The Indian optical market is very dynamic. With the growth and penetration of laptop and desktops across India, storage requirements is also increasing at a rapid rate. However, since last year, the trend in optical sales is going down with the price of flash drives and hard disks dropping drastically and capacities increasing. Imation has launched its latest Defender series of CDs and DVDs having password protection and encryption facility that will help the customer to save and protect its data, and we feel such value added features will help us play a key role in India.

Since Imation is planning a strong foray into the Indian market, what can we expect?

The Indian market is crucial for Imation, and we have a line-up of new products. This includes the latest launch



Kiran Nair, Country Leader, Imation India

of Defender series of Imation CDs and DVDs with encryption features such as password protection, and other similar encryption features. The Defender series Flash drives and hard disks with biometric feature and FIPS certified products have also been launched. Our range of PC accessories that includes PC headphones, mice, keyboard combos, and web cams is also doing good.

Will Imation diversify into other product categories to gain a strong foothold in this price sensitive market?

Yes, we are looking forward for various options and will be launching the same soon.

Can we see a further drop in prices in the near future?

India being a price conscious market, and with capacities in personal storage segment growing, price will be dropping regularly. We can see the same in hard disks, flash drives and other products in the IT accessories range.